

Shakespeare's Literary Techniques

William Shakespeare (1564-1616) employed various literary devices.

Dramatic Irony: The audience knows something characters do not.

Soliloquy: A speech revealing inner thoughts, like Hamlet's 'To be or not to be'.

Iambic Pentameter: Lines of ten syllables with alternating stress.

Themes Across Works:

- Power and ambition (Macbeth, Julius Caesar)
- Love and complications (A Midsummer Night's Dream)
- Appearance versus reality (The Tempest, Othello)
- Justice and mercy (The Merchant of Venice)